Business IT Management

Program Overview

Success in the workplace in the twenty-first century can hardly be achieved without knowledge, skills, and experience in using modern technology and its components, such as information and communication technology (ICT), computer-based systems, and business applications.

The Business IT Management program combines business and information technology to enable students to gain a thorough understanding of how IT and computer applications improve effectiveness, increase efficiency, and facilitate business operations.

Students are thoroughly exposed to the business uses of database management, programming, networking, telecommunications, e-commerce, the internet, and online development.

To obtain a Bachelor of Business Administration degree in Business IT Management, the student must complete 99 credit hours. These hours include University requirements (UR), College requirements (CR), and Program requirements (PR). The allocation of the credit hours is shown in the following table:

BBA in Business IT Management (99 Credits)						
Courses Category	Major		Non-Major		Credits	Percent
	Mandatory	Electives	Mandatory	Electives		
General Education	3	-	15	12	30	30
College Requirement	3	-	38	-	41	41
Program Requirement	25	3	-	-	28	28
Total Credits	31	3	53	12	99	100

I. University Requirements (General Education)

The list of the university's required courses and their descriptions is presented in the introductory pages of the College of Business Administration section in this catalog.

II. College Requirements

The list of college-required courses and descriptions is presented on the introductory pages of the College of Business Administration section of this catalog.

III. Program Requirements

A. Mandatory Requirements

The mandatory Business IT Management program courses are listed in the table below.

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
BADM 485	Co-op Work Experience	1	ENGL 217; Senior Standing
BADM 490	Entrepreneurship	3	Senior Standing
BITM 305	Introduction to Programming	3	BITM 200
BITM 310	Database Management Systems	3	BITM 305
BITM 340	The Development Tools of Information Systems	3	BITM 305
BITM 355	Networking	3	Junior Standing
BITM 415	Business Intelligence	3	Senior Standing
BITM 450	Big Data Analytics	3	BITM 350
BMGT 300	Project Management	3	Junior Standing
	Major Elective Course	3	

B. Major Electives

As part of the Bachelor of Business Administration in Business IT Management program, the student must study 3 credit hours of major electives. Major electives could be upper-level courses in Accounting or closely related business or computing areas. These courses allow students to focus on a specific area for in-depth knowledge and understanding. Meanwhile, they introduce flexibility into the program, allowing the integration of emerging topics.

In consultation with the academic advisor, the student should select the elective course that best aligns with their needs and aspirations. It is highly recommended that the student register for these courses after completing the Departmental requirements. The table below lists some recommendations for major elective courses:

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
BACC 350	Accounting Information Systems	3	BACC 205, BITM 300
BADM 480	Independent Studies	3	Advisor's approval
BITM 320	Enterprise Resource Planning	3	BITM 300
BITM 402	Advanced Web Programming	3	BITM 400
BITM 410	Advanced Programming and Data Structures	3	BITM 305
BITM 455	Advanced Networking	3	BITM 355

Moreover, under certain conditions specified by the department and subject to the advisor's approval, a student may take BADM 480 (independent studies) as a substitute for a program's mandatory course. The course's description is below.

C. Entrepreneurship

The instructor leads the students through the detailed aspects of starting a business, from identifying an opportunity and conducting a feasibility study to preparing a business plan covering marketing, operations, and finance. Students also learn about funding, expansion, and franchising strategies. **Prerequisite:** Senior Standing.

D. Co-op Work Experience

Each student must complete 8 weeks of practical training in a field related to their interests. The Co-op experience is usually fulfilled during the summer semester of the third year in the program. The Co-op office matches the Co-op assignment with the student's field of study and the employer's interest. A faculty member follows up on a student's progress throughout the Co-op period by conducting field visits and ensuring that the student's performance is aligned with their aspirations and the employer's needs. Students must then submit formal reports and posters and make formal presentations about their Co-op experience. While ENGL 217 and Senior Standing are prerequisites for co-op training, the program must stipulate additional conditions.

Career Opportunities

An increasing number of companies and entrepreneurial ventures in the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) region have sought to capitalize on the computing and information technology revolution to enable and facilitate business operations in areas such as telemarketing, e-commerce, e-government, and social media. This creates numerous job opportunities for people with skills in online sales, electronic market research, e-commerce, online transaction security, mobile application development, and information systems management.

Program Goals and Student Learning Outcomes

The purpose of the Business IT Management Program at the College of Business Administration of Rafik Hariri University is an integrative composite of four main dimensions: General and Specialized Business Knowledge, Communication, Critical Thinking, and Growth Potential.

General & Specialized Business Knowledge

Goal 1	Prepare graduates with effective professional competence in conducting critical business activities, particularly those related to Business Information Technology Management.
Outcome 1	Apply essential business knowledge and skills in problem-solving and decision-making.
Outcome 2	Use ICT tools and programs to enhance performance and improve operational business efficiency.

Communication

Goal 2	Equip graduates with the knowledge and skills to secure placements in business, IT management, and systems positions.
Outcome 3	Demonstrate written and oral English communication skills adequate for challenging entry- and middle-level professional positions and self-employment.

Critical thinking

Goal 3	Promote analytical and critical thinking in approaching business issues and problems.
Outcome 4	Identify business problems, analyze them, and present plausible solutions.

Ethics and Social Responsibility

Goal 4	Raise awareness about ethics and social responsibility to promote better business for a better community.
Outcome 5	Recognize ethical dilemmas in business and respond to them in accordance with standard codes of conduct, ethical principles, and best practices.

Study Plan

The Bachelor of Business Administration in Business IT Management encompasses 99 credit hours over six semesters and two summer sessions. The second summer session should be dedicated to the Community Engagement Experience. Meanwhile, the third session should be for the Co-op work experience. The following study plan serves as a roadmap for a smooth progression toward graduation.

Course #	Title	Credits	Prerequisites
Year 1, Fall Semester (16 Credits)			
BACC 205	Financial Accounting	3	
BADM 215	Personal Development and Management	1	
BITM 200	Information Technology Essentials	3	
BMGT 200	Introduction to Management	3	Co-req.: ENGL 210.
ENGL 210	English Composition and Rhetoric	3	ENGL 101
MATH 207	College Algebra*	3	Placement
Year 1, Spring Semester (16 Credits)			
BACC 255	Financial Accounting	3	BACC 205
BADM 225	Business Math	3	Placement
BADM 235	Business Research Methodology	1	
BADM 250	Business Statistics	3	
BMKA 200	Introduction to Marketing	3	Co-req.: ENGL 210
BITM 305	Introduction to Programming	3	BITM 200

Year 2, Fall Semester (18 Credits)			
BADM 230	Business Law	3	
BECN 301	Microeconomics	3	Junior Standing
BFIN 300	Financial Management I	3	BACC 205
BITM 300	Business IT Management	3	BITM 200
BITM 310	Database Management Systems	3	BITM 305
ENGL 217	Professional English Communication	3	ENGL 210
Year 2, Spring Semester (18 Credits)			
BECN 302	Macroeconomics	3	Junior Standing
BITM 340	Development Tools of Information Systems	3	BITM 305
BITM 350	Fundamentals of Data Analytics	3	BADM 250 or MATH 351.
BMGT 300	Project Management	3	Junior Standing
	Science Elective	3	
	Humanities / Fine Arts Elective	3	
Year 2, Summer Semester (0 Credits)			
BADM 290	Community Engagement Experience	0	
Year 3, Fall Semester (15 Credits)			
BADM 355	Business Ethics and Social Responsibility	3	Junior Standing
BITM 415	Business Intelligence	3	Senior Standing
BITM 355	Networking	3	Junior Standing
BITM 450	Big Data Analytics	3	BITM 350
	Social Science Elective	3	
Year 3, Spring Semester (15 Credits)			
ARAB 212	Arabic Language and Communication	2	
BADM 420	Quantitative Methods for Business	3	BADM 250 or MATH 351 or Senior Standing
BADM 490	Entrepreneurship	3	Senior Standing
	Community & Sustainability	1	Co-req.: ENGL 210
	Major Elective	3	
	Social Science Elective	3	
Year 3, Summer Semester (1 Credit)			
BADM 485	Co-op Work Experience	1	ENGL 217; Senior Standing

* Students exempted from this course based on their score on the mathematics placement exam will select a free elective course as a substitute for it.

Courses Description

I. Mandatory Courses

Descriptions of the major mandatory courses are given below.

BADM 485	Co-op Work Experience	1(0,1)
The Co-op work experience is designed to provide students with full-time work terms in business, industry, or government. The main thrust of this course is the opportunity to put into practice the major aspects of the student's business education. Special emphasis will be placed on assessing the student's attitude and work ethics. Students will be encouraged to network in the industry and to participate in professional organizations. **Prerequisite:** ENGL 217; Senior Standing.		

BADM 490	Entrepreneurship
The instructor leads the students through the detailed aspects of starting a business, from identifying an opportunity and conducting a feasibility study to preparing a business plan covering marketing, operations, and finance. Students also learn about funding, expansion, and franchising strategies. **Prerequisite:** Senior Standing.	

BITM 305	Introduction to Programming	3(2,2)
This is a foundation course for all computer programming courses. It enhances programming skills and presents the fundamentals of structured programming concepts in C. The course covers primitive data types, expressions, control statements, functions, and arrays. It also provides a hands-on experience with MATLAB. **Prerequisite:** BITM 200 (equivalent to COSC 214).		

BITM 310	Database Management Systems	3(3,1)
Students will explore advanced database concepts, including automation techniques, using popular Windows-based DBMS software. The course includes the following topics: the planning, creation, and maintenance of databases; the development of information retrieval techniques; the design and customization of forms; and the creation and use of macros and modules in an automated system. **Prerequisite:** BITM 305; equivalent to COSC 231 and CCEE 315.		

BITM 340	The Development Tools of Information Systems	3(3,0)
This course offers a traditional look at the system's life cycle process. Modeling and charting will be included. The tools and methodology applied by the systems analyst will be studied. The course covers an overview of the system life cycle, UML Diagrams, feasibility analysis, project management, HCI, and the golden rules of user interface design. **Prerequisite:** BITM 305; equivalent to COSC 341 and CCEE 510.		

BITM 355	Networking	3(2,2)
An introduction to data communications and networking, covering networking hardware/operating system concepts, modems, WAN, and LAN standards and protocols. **Prerequisite:** Junior Standing; Equivalent to COSC 360, CCEE 354.		

BITM 401	Web Programming	3(3,1)
This course teaches students how to develop and implement web-based programs, with an emphasis on interface programming. It introduces students to web development, client-side languages, and the styles needed to build functional, responsive websites. The course covers HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript/jQuery, and responsive design. Equivalent to COSC 333, CCEE 411.		

BITM 415	Business Intelligence	3(2,1)
This course introduces business intelligence as computerized support for managerial decision-making. It focuses on the theoretical and conceptual foundations of business intelligence, as well as on commercial tools and techniques for effective decision support. It focuses on extracting business intelligence from data sets for various applications, such as reporting and visual analytics across domains like web and business analytics, to aid decision-making. Provides hands-on experience with a variety of business intelligence software for reporting and building visualizations and dashboards. **Prerequisite:** Senior Standing.		

BITM 450	Big Data Analytics	3(2,1)
This course provides students with a comprehensive understanding of big data analytics from a Business Information Technology (BIT) perspective, with a strong emphasis on Apache Hadoop and its ecosystem. The course focuses on how organizations leverage Hadoop-based platforms to store, process, analyze, and derive value from large-scale business data. Students will gain hands-on experience with HDFS, MapReduce, Hive, HBase, Pig, and ZooKeeper, and learn how these technologies support business intelligence, operational analytics, and managerial decision-making. The course prioritizes practical Hadoop applications, business use cases, and the interpretation of analytical outputs over advanced algorithmic theory. Through lectures, laboratory exercises, assignments, and a group project, students will design and implement end-to-end Hadoop-based analytics solutions to address real-world business problems. **Prerequisite**: BITM 350		

BMGT 300	Project Management	3(3,0)
This course provides students with the skills to manage their business projects by effectively leading, organizing, scheduling, and controlling tasks to achieve project goals. Topics include project selection and statement of work, project manager skills, task breakdown structure, PERT/CPM scheduling, and budgeting. **Prerequisite:** Junior Standing.		

II. Elective Courses

Descriptions of some elective courses are given below.

BACC 350	Accounting Information Systems	3(3,0)
This course is designed to give students an in-depth understanding of accounting information systems. It introduces the student to file and database organization,		

business processes, internal controls, the systems development process, and the management of information systems. Moreover, end-user application software includes "off-the-shelf" accounting software packages and spreadsheets. **Prerequisite:** BACC 205; BITM 300.

BADM 480	**Independent Studies**	**3(3,0)**
This course focuses on advancing the student's knowledge in their specialization through independent research and application on current or emerging topics, as approved by the assigned faculty member. **Prerequisite:** Advisor's approval.		

BITM 320	Enterprise Resource Planning	
Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) systems are a major investment for businesses. These systems are essential for maintaining competitiveness, meeting customer demands, and improving efficiency and flexibility in a global marketplace. By adopting ERP, companies can streamline their operations, align with industry best practices, and fully utilize integrated data resources. This course will provide students with the skills and knowledge needed to plan, design, and implement ERP systems effectively. Prerequisite: BITM 300		

BITM 402	**Advanced Web Programming**	**3(3,1)**
This course focuses on server-side programming. It allows students to learn how to connect their website or web application to a database and to save and retrieve data from it. The course exposes students to web controls, validation controls, data source controls, data binding controls, state management, and working with third-party media like XML and web services. **Prerequisite:** BITM 401; equivalent to COSC 434 and CCEE 514.		

BITM 410	**Advanced Programming and Data Structures**	**3(3,1)**
This is a continuation course using advanced C++. The student studies object-oriented programming concepts such as classes, objects, polymorphism, data hiding, and encapsulation. This course gives the student a new perspective on how to think about objects. **Prerequisite:** BITM 305; equivalent to COSC 215 and CCEE 216.		

BITM 455	**Advanced Networking**	**3(2,2)**
This course prepares students to act as System and Network Administrators by implementing Active Directory Domain Services ADDS in distributed environments that can include complex network services and domain controllers. The covered materials help students efficiently automate the administration of users, groups, and computers. **Prerequisite:** BITM 355, Equivalent to COSC 461.		